

# Realme C65 5G

## The perks of 5G with minimal compromises

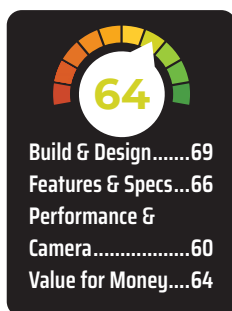
**T**he rampant democratisation of 5G in India is birthing a new era of affordable 5G-enabled phones with a few compromises to keep the costs in check. The Realme C65 joins the pack of bang-for-your-buck 5G phones, which consists of phones like the Lava Blaze 2 5G and POCO M6 Pro 5G. The C65 5G succeeds the popular Realme C55. Since its predecessor was a 4G-only device, it automatically makes the upgrade to 5G one of the C65's most prominent upgrades. That aside, the Realme C65 features an array of improvements such as a more powerful processor, IP54 protection, an improved primary camera, and a faster 120 Hz refresh rate. There are also some downgrades too. Notably, the reduction of fast charging speeds. So, will the Realme C65 make an impact in the budget 5G smartphone market, or will it crash and burn because of stronger competition? Let's delve into the review to find out.

### BUILD AND DESIGN

Equipped with a pleasing design, the Realme C65's Feather Green colour variant mimics the feather-like rear panel design of the recently launched Realme P1. Soft feather strokes grace the phone's matte plastic back, making it stand out from the crowd at first glance. Realme's signature circular camera island makes its way to a C-series phone for the first time as well. This is also one of the slimmest and lightest 5G phones in this price range, beating out competitors such as the Lava Blaze 2 and POCO M6 Pro.

The phone's frame is also made of polycarbonate and the edges are

₹10,499



completely flat, much like its predecessor. While the phone is lightweight, the sharp edges make it uncomfortable to hold for longer periods. However, if you plop on the included transparent case, the issue is resolved. The phone houses a side-mounted fingerprint sensor that's one

of the fastest I've tested at this price. Additionally, you also get IP54 dust and water resistance; the POCO M6 Pro 5G also offers ingress protection, but it is limited to IP53.

The C65 doesn't upgrade to a stereo speaker setup, but the single speaker is loud enough for indoor usage in small to medium-sized rooms. The phone also features a 3.5 mm audio jack and an expandable memory slot for SD cards.

### DISPLAY

The Realme C65's display is a mixed bag. It flaunts a 6.67-inch IPS LCD panel with 120 Hz refresh rate support. Sadly, the resolution is bumped down from Full HD+ to HD+, which means

it is not as sharp as the C55's display. The POCO M6 Pro provides a Full HD+ display at a similar price but has only 90 Hz refresh rate.

Personally, the upgrade to the refresh rate justifies the sacrifice of display quality at this price. The phone doesn't support HDR, but Widevine L1 allows you to stream HD content on OTT platforms which the phone is perfectly capable of running well. The 120 Hz refresh rate makes the phone feel smoother, which is imperative at this price point where processors are not as powerful. So, the Realme C65's display is not perfect – viewing angles are mediocre and the brightness only touched 528 nits on HBM in our testing, but the smooth 120 Hz refresh rate makes up for some of these misses.

### PERFORMANCE

The Realme C65 5G is powered by the MediaTek Dimensity 6030 processor and features up to 6 GB LPDDR4X RAM and up to 128 GB UFS 2.2 storage. However, the base variant that costs ₹10,499 (without discounts) only has 4 GB RAM and 64 GB internal storage. While the RAM is acceptable for the price, 64 GB storage is far too dated for 2024 when our storage needs are skyrocketing.

The phone does support external memory via a microSD card, it is almost guaranteed that most users would need to shell out extra money for an SD card since 64 GB simply doesn't cut it now. I hope Realme defaults to 128 GB going forward as many brands are doing in 2024.

The performance of my 6 GB + 128 GB review unit was more than satisfactory though. The phone breezes through day-to-day tasks with ease; you can confidently run common apps such as WhatsApp, YouTube, Facebook, and more without the worry of excessive lag. Multitasking on the 6 GB unit was also great for the price.

In benchmarks, the Realme C65, once again, had a strong showing. It got a solid score of 4,30,291 in AnTuTu v10 which was only beaten by the POCO M6 Pro by a slight margin. In GeekBench,